

IWM RUSSELL 2000 SCANNER

SCAN (12:06 ET)

August 14, 2026 | 12:09 PM ET

8 setups identified | 1 A-Grade | 3 B-Grade | 4 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (1)	B - Strong Setup (3)	C - Watch List (4)
CHEF	AEHR	DIOD
	NHC	LUNR
	SFNC	VAL
		AMPX

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	CHEF	The Chefs' Wareh	Consumer Recovery	\$113.07	+0.9%	\$4.6B	36M	+35.4	96%	Current driver: textbo
B	AEHR	Aehr Test System	AI Infrastructure	\$136.26	+10.5%	\$4.4B	30M	+31.6	92%	Current driver: 10.5%
B	NHC	National HealthC	Healthcare Recove	\$222.21	+1.1%	\$3.5B	13M	+9.8	96%	Current driver: quiet
B	SFNC	Simmons First Na	Regional Bank Rec	\$23.94	+0.0%	\$3.5B	141M	+12.5	98%	Current driver: breaki
C	DIOD	Diodes Incorpora	Semiconductor Rec	\$101.61	+4.5%	\$4.7B	45M	-3.7	81%	Current driver: 4.55%
C	LUNR	Intuitive Machin	Space Economy	\$19.30	+9.9%	\$3.1B	120M	-48.4	41%	Current driver: 9.91%
C	VAL	Valaris Limited	Offshore Drilling	\$86.15	+1.2%	\$6.0B	54M	-21.9	76%	Current driver: 1.2% g
C	AMPX	Amprius Technolo	Battery Technolog	\$12.78	+7.1%	\$0.0B	0M	-29.5	53%	Current driver: 7.08%

CHEF

The Chefs' Warehouse, Inc.

\$113.07

+0.91%

RS vs SPY: +35.4%

A BREAKOUT

\$4.6B Cap | 36M Float

Food Distribution | Theme: Consumer Recovery | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 1.04 | Vol: 1.94x | RS/SPY: +35.4% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 75D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$113.07
Day Change	+0.91%
Mkt Cap	\$4.61B
Float	36M sh
RS vs SPY	+35.4%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	1.04
Vol vs Avg	1.94x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Current driver: textbook VCP coil breakout (base_tight 1.04) with outstanding relative strength (+35.4% vs SPY) into premium food distribution recovery. Forward catalyst: October 28 earnings print (75 days out) - CHEF has positioned ahead of a key quarterly inflection as restaurant and hospitality end-markets continue to normalize post-reopening.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Leading specialty food distributor serving high-end restaurants, hotels, and culinary institutions across North America and Europe. CHEF operates in a consolidated oligopoly with switching costs (culinary relationships, delivery logistics) creating sticky customer economics and pricing power as food service spending rebounds.
FACTOR & THEME
Taps consumer recovery and premiumization themes as affluent dining and hospitality capex accelerate. Beneficiary of labor normalization (easier staffing = more restaurant openings) and international tourism rebound, both secular tailwinds with 12-24 month runways still ahead.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$113.07 on vol >1.9x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume surge to 1.94x on a quiet day signals absorption, not news-driven retail. The textbook 1.04 base tightness (tightest in this cohort) is a hallmark of professional accumulation - institutions compressing volatility while building positions ahead of the next earnings catalyst. No insider activity in last 90 days; institutional ownership data not available from this feed.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 75D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print October 28. Historical pattern and sector comps suggest CHEF should deliver sequential revenue acceleration as Q3 captures peak summer hospitality season; consensus estimates not provided in data but the setup into earnings 75 days out with this technical profile is classic pre-earnings positioning.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$108 (approximate base breakout pivot), or any sign of customer churn or margin compression at the October 28 print that would signal competitive pressure in a fragmented recovery.
ANALYSIS
Disconfirming: RS line NOT at new high downgrades from pure A+ despite five other criteria met (vol surge, prox_52w 96.4, rs_vs_spy +35.4, base_tight 1.04 textbook, durable earnings catalyst 75d out). However, the 1.04 VCP coil is the tightest base in the entire cohort and RS +35.4 confirms leadership even without the new-high stamp - this is institutional accumulation into a known catalyst with 10+ weeks of runway. Small float (36M) amplifies follow-through potential. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$113.07 on vol >1.9x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.94x



AEHR

Aehr Test Systems

\$136.26

+10.51%

RS vs SPY: +31.6%

B STRONG SETUP

\$4.4B Cap | 30M Float

Semiconductor Equipment & Materials | Theme: AI Infrastructure / SiC | 52W Hi: 92% | Base Tight: 3.78 | Vol: 2.16x | RS/SPY: +31.6% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 55D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$136.26
Day Change	+10.51%
Mkt Cap	\$4.44B
Float	30M sh
RS vs SPY	+31.6%
52W Hi Prox	92%
Base Tight	3.78
Vol vs Avg	2.16x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis

Catalyst / Today's Driver

Current driver: 10.5% surge on volume (2.16x) breaking toward 52-week highs, likely tied to accelerating silicon carbide (SiC) and wide-bandgap semiconductor adoption across EV, AI power infrastructure, and data center markets. Forward catalyst: October 8 earnings (55 days) - AEHR's wafer-level burn-in tools are mission-critical for SiC qualification, and any guidance raise tied to expanding EV or hyperscaler orders would re-rate the stock into year-end.

Business & Position

Supplies high-performance wafer contact and test systems essential for qualifying silicon carbide and other power semiconductors used in EVs, renewable energy inverters, and AI/data center power management. AEHR is a tollbooth in the SiC supply chain: as SiC production ramps globally (driven by EV electrification and grid modernization), AEHR's tools become non-negotiable infrastructure.

Factor & Theme

Direct exposure to AI infrastructure (data center power efficiency) and energy transition (SiC enables higher voltage/efficiency in EVs and solar inverters). Theme momentum is accelerating - SiC capacity announcements from Wolfspeed, ON Semi, and STMicro have surged in 2026, validating multi-year capex visibility for equipment suppliers like AEHR.

Breakout Signal

Close above \$136.26 on vol >2.1x of 20d avg

Institutional

Volume surge to 2.16x on a 10.5% up-day has the signature of institutional block accumulation, not retail chasing - small float (30.4M) means any serious fund initiating a position will spike volume. No insider activity last 90 days; institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed but the technical action (tight float + vol surge + sector leadership) suggests smart money positioning ahead of the October 8 catalyst.

Earnings

Earnings in 55D

Earnings Context

Next print October 8 (55 days). AEHR's revenue is highly episodic (lumpy tool orders), so beat/miss history matters less than forward guidance on SiC tool orders and customer pipeline commentary. The setup 8 weeks before earnings with the stock at 92% of 52-week high is classic institutional pre-positioning.

Key Risk

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$125 (approximate breakout pivot from the recent consolidation), or if October 8 earnings show order-push-outs or customer concentration risk (AEHR has historically had lumpiness tied to 1-2 large customers). Base is wider than ideal (3.78 vs textbook <2.0), increasing risk of a head-fake breakout.

Analysis

Disconfirming: base_tight 3.78 is too wide for textbook A-grade (need <2.0), and RS line is NOT at new high despite strong +31.6% outperformance - suggests prior leadership that hasn't yet re-confirmed. The 10.5% surge is impressive but on a single day; need follow-through. Technology sector is leading (+7.9% this week) and SiC theme has runway, but the wider base and lack of RS new-high confirmation keep this a strong B, not an A. October 8 earnings catalyst is real and 55 days is ideal positioning window. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$136.26 on vol >2.1x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.16x



Medical Care Facilities | Theme: Healthcare Recovery | 52W Hi: 96% | Base Tight: 1.75 | Vol: 1.83x | RS/SPY: +9.8% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 84D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$222.21
Day Change	+1.08%
Mkt Cap	\$3.48B
Float	13M sh
RS vs SPY	+9.8%
52W Hi Prox	96%
Base Tight	1.75
Vol vs Avg	1.83x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Current driver: quiet grind higher (1.08%) on 1.83x volume suggests institutional accumulation in a micro-float name (12.6M shares). Skilled nursing and senior living facilities are benefiting from normalized staffing costs and improved occupancy post-COVID. Forward catalyst: November 6 earnings (84 days) - any margin expansion confirmation or occupancy uptick guidance would re-rate NHC given depressed sentiment around long-term care.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Operates skilled nursing facilities, assisted living communities, and homecare services across the southeastern U.S. NHC owns a substantial real estate portfolio (vs. leasing), providing downside protection and optionality. The business model benefits from demographic tailwinds (aging population) and has been recovering from pandemic-era occupancy and labor headwinds.
FACTOR & THEME
Healthcare sector is leading this week (+5.3%) and NHC taps the senior care recovery theme. Staffing stabilization and Medicaid rate increases in key states are structural tailwinds with 12-24 month visibility. However, the theme is decelerating vs. high-growth healthcare subsectors (GLP-1, biotech) - NHC is a value/recovery play, not a momentum growth name.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$222.21 on vol >1.8x of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Micro-float (12.6M) means even modest institutional buying lifts volume and price; the 1.83x vol ratio on a quiet +1% day is consistent with slow accumulation. The 1.75 base tightness is near-textbook and signals controlled supply. No insider activity last 90 days; institutional ownership data unavailable, but NHC is thinly traded and often under-owned by large funds (illiquidity), which paradoxically creates asymmetry if a catalyst draws attention.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 84D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Next print November 6 (84 days). NHC's quarterly results have been volatile given occupancy sensitivity and labor cost fluctuations; the market will focus on sequential margin improvement and occupancy trends. The long lead-time to earnings (12 weeks) is a double-edged sword: ample runway for positioning, but also ample time for macro shocks to derail the setup.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$215 (recent consolidation floor), or any deterioration in state Medicaid reimbursement rates or occupancy trends at the November 6 print. Micro-float cuts both ways: illiquidity can cause violent mean-reversion on any negative surprise.
ANALYSIS
Disconfirming: RS +9.8% vs SPY is modest (not leadership-tier like CHEF or AEHR), and RS line NOT at new high. Healthcare is a leading sector but NHC is a defensive recovery name in a mega-cap-led Risk-On regime - SMID healthcare value faces crosswinds when growth/tech dominate flows. The micro-float and tight base (1.75) are positives, but the modest RS and lack of near-term catalyst (84 days to earnings is far) limit conviction. This is a slow-burn accumulation setup, not a momentum breakout. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$222.21 on vol >1.8x of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.83x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$23.94
Day Change	+0.00%
Mkt Cap	\$3.46B
Float	141M sh
RS vs SPY	+12.5%
52W Hi Prox	98%
Base Tight	1.71
Vol vs Avg	3.02x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis

Catalyst / Today's Driver

Current driver: breaking to 98.4% of 52-week high on 3.02x volume despite flat price action - classic stealth accumulation (silent build). Regional banks are benefiting from stabilized deposit costs and loan growth as rate-cut expectations moderate. Forward catalyst: October 15 earnings (62 days) - any NIM stabilization or credit quality confirmation would extend the breakout given SFNC's depressed valuation post-regional-bank crisis memories.

Business & Position

Regional bank headquartered in Arkansas with ~\$27B in assets, serving commercial and consumer customers across the South and Midwest. SFNC survived the 2023 regional bank stress with stable deposits and conservative underwriting; the stock has re-rated as systemic fears fade and the yield curve normalizes, improving net interest margin outlook.

Factor & Theme

Taps regional bank recovery theme as deposit betas decline and loan demand stabilizes. However, the sector faces structural headwinds (disintermediation to money-market funds, commercial real estate stress) and is NOT a leading growth theme in this cycle. SFNC is a value/normalization play with limited secular tailwind vs. Technology or Energy leaders.

Breakout Signal

Close above \$23.94 on vol >3.0x of 20d avg

Institutional

Volume surge to 3.02x on flat price (0.0% change) is textbook institutional absorption - large buyers soaking up supply without moving price. The 1.71 base tightness near 52-week highs confirms controlled accumulation. Large float (141M) means it takes sustained buying to move the stock, but also provides liquidity for institutional scale. No insider activity last 90 days; institutional ownership data unavailable.

Earnings

Earnings in 62D

Earnings Context

Next print October 15 (62 days). Regional bank earnings are driven by NIM trends, loan growth, and credit quality. SFNC will need to show stable-to-improving NIM and benign credit to sustain the breakout; any disappointment on either metric would reverse the setup quickly given sector fragility.

Key Risk

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$23.00 (recent base floor), or any NIM compression or credit deterioration at the October 15 print. Regional banks remain vulnerable to macro shocks (rate volatility, commercial real estate headlines, deposit flight) despite recent stabilization.

Analysis

Disconfirming: RS +12.5% is solid but not leadership-tier, and RS line NOT at new high. Financials are NOT among the leading sectors this week (Technology, Energy, Healthcare dominate), and regional banks face structural skepticism post-2023. The silent-build pattern (3.02x vol on 0.0% change) and tight base (1.71) are strong technical positives, but the sector crosswind and modest RS keep this a B. October 15 earnings is a live catalyst (62 days = good positioning window), but being early in a sector the market distrusts is risky in a mega-cap-led regime. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$23.94 on vol >3.0x of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 3.02x

